06. Windows Security Event IDs

1. What Is a Windows Event ID?

Definition: A Windows Event ID is a numeric identifier used to distinguish a particular type of event recorded in a Windows event log.

Event IDs help analysts search and investigate logon activity, account changes, service creation and other security-relevant events.

2. Table of 15 Important Event IDs

Event ID	Meaning	When to Use It
4624	Successful logon	Identify successful access and logon type
4625	Failed logon	Investigate repeated authentication failures
4634	Account logged off	Review when a logon session ended
4648	Logon attempted using explicit credentials	Investigate use of alternate credentials
4672	Special privileges assigned to a new logon	Review logons with sensitive privileges
4688	A new process has been created	Investigate suspicious process execution
4697	A service was installed in the system	Investigate unexpected service installation
4720	A user account was created	Find newly created accounts
4722	A user account was enabled	Investigate account reactivation
4724	An attempt was made to reset an account's password	Review password-reset activity
4732	A member was added to a security-enabled local group	Investigate additions to local Administrators
4768	A Kerberos authentication ticket-granting ticket (TGT) was requested	Investigate Kerberos authentication
4769	A Kerberos service ticket was requested	Review access to Kerberos-protected services

4776	The computer attempted to validate credentials using NTLM	Investigate NTLM authentication and failures
1102	The Security audit log was cleared	Investigate possible removal of security evidence

3. Important Investigation Notes

- **4624:** Check the account, source address where available, timestamp and logon type.
- **4625:** Review the target account, failure reason, source address and frequency.
- **4648:** Determine why alternate credentials were used and which process initiated the activity.
- **4672:** The event alone does not prove malicious activity; privileged accounts may generate it normally.
- **4688:** Review process name, parent process and command line when the relevant audit settings capture them.
- **4697:** Confirm whether the service installation was authorized.
- **4720 and 4722:** Verify account creation and account enablement with the system owner.
- **4732:** Check which group was changed and who performed the change.
- **4768, 4769 and 4776:** Correlate with account, host, authentication method and surrounding events.
- **1102:** Investigate who cleared the log, when it happened and whether other evidence remains.

4. Important Notes for Analysts

- Some events appear only when the corresponding audit policy is enabled.
- Event 4697 may not be recorded in every configuration; also review the System log for service-installation Event ID 7045.
- Event 4732 applies to local security-enabled groups; domain group changes may use different Event IDs.
- Event 1102 concerns the Security audit log, not every Windows log.
- A single Event ID rarely tells the whole story. Correlate multiple events and other evidence.

5. Conclusion

Windows Event IDs provide useful evidence about authentication, account management, process execution, services and log clearing. SOC analysts correlate events with timestamps, account names, source devices and expected behaviour before reaching a conclusion.